FULL PLATE · RESTAURANT MANAGER GAME

Round 11 report

Red-team fixes, the re-aim at a 14-year-old (Round 11b), and how the game compares with what a 14-year-old actually plays

Prepared for Daniel · 10 November 2026 · Game version 12 (commit `5c5508b`) · replaces the version-11 report issued earlier today, which assumed a 10-year-old

39 / 43
red-team findings closed; 4 partly; 0 open

1,241
automated tests passing (was 1,071)

71 → 1
underlined "learn this word" terms on the day-1 Menu

12 / 20
Stars games reaching a dynasty by year 10 (was 3 / 20)

Contents — 1. The short version · 2. What changed in Round 11 · 3. Round 11b: re-aimed at 14 · 4. Every finding and its status · 5. The numbers · 6. In pictures · 7. How Full Plate compares with what a 14-year-old plays · 8. Ideas worth borrowing · 9. What's next · Sources

1. The short version

Last round, a red-team review of the code and the game found 43 problems: ways a bad save file could crash the game on every device, ways a player could lose quietly and have her restaurant deleted, end-games that were unwinnable or exploitable, and a layout that broke on an iPad held upright. Round 11 fixed them. Five builders worked in parallel, one per area, then a reviewer merged their work, re-ran every one of the red team's own reproductions, and checked the game balance, size and playability.

Round 11 also, by mistake, aimed the game's *words* at a 10-year-old: kitchen slang replaced with nursery phrasing, alcohol hidden by default, a dotted "learn this word" underline on 71 words of the first Menu screen. The brief had always said 12+, and your daughter is 14. **Round 11b undid that** on your two decisions: real drinks are back on by default (the "hide" switch stays), and the trade words are back on screen, each with its meaning one tap away. The review voices were rewritten for a teenager, Normal is the default difficulty, and the goals card stops nudging after the first week.

> **The result:** 39 of the 43 findings are closed, with the red team's own attack scripts now failing to do any harm; the remaining 4 are partly fixed and listed in section 4. Game balance is identical to before, row for row. The game is published as version 12 and pushed to GitHub. None of the safety and losing fixes depended on age; they all stand.

What she will notice

- **It talks to her like a colleague.** "86" means 86, "comp", "tronc", "HQ", "royalty", "VAT" and "footfall" are the real words; tapping any of them shows a one-line meaning. The underline that marks a tappable word shows once per word, not every time, and can be switched off.
- **A real drinks list.** Pint of lager, glass of house wine, prosecco. "Hide alcoholic drinks" in Settings swaps them for a proper temperance list (rhubarb & rose pressé rather than "fizzy apple") and the game plays identically either way.
- **Drier jokes.** "Our tummies were rumbling" became "We read the whole menu. Twice." Fifty-one review, critic, event and staff lines were rewritten; the ones that were already funny stayed.
- **Normal by default.** She can go bust, the bank counts down, inspectors visit unannounced. Cosy is still there, still at 4× speed, for anyone who wants it.
- **She can't lose her restaurant by accident.** A header chip counts down "Bank: N days left"; an evening card explains what to do; a lost game is kept in "Your games" with *Start over with the same restaurant* instead of being deleted.
- **Big spends ask first** ("This leaves you with £630 — are you sure?"), anything unaffordable is greyed out with the reason, and the bank will lend a first wage once.
- **It works on an iPad held upright** as well as sideways, with no sideways scrolling anywhere. **Phone-sized screens have never been tested**; see section 9.
- **Nothing from outside can break it.** Every save file is checked before it's trusted; a damaged one is refused with "That save file is damaged." rather than white-screening the game.

How it compares (section 7)

Three analysts surveyed 50-odd games, the last one looking specifically at what 14-year-old girls in the UK play: Roblox (where two-thirds of daily users are now 13+), *Dress to Impress*, *The Sims*, *Stardew Valley*, PlateUp!, Overcooked, Two Point and Dave the Diver. Full Plate still wins every safety row a parent cares about (no ads, purchases, chat, loot boxes or tracking), and for depth it sits level with the PC tycoons. At 14, though, she chooses for herself, and it loses the rows she cares about: **self-expression** (no logo, uniforms or colour scheme, though the brief asked for them), **friends** (nothing shared or co-op), **humour with an edge**, a **soundtrack**, and **her phone**. The analyst's verdict on "does it feel for a little kid" was: in places yes, and the

cause was Round 11's wording, not the game underneath; Round 11b fixed exactly those places. Section 8 re-ranks the borrowable ideas for 14: a brand kit, a daily challenge she can beat you on, and a postcard she can post in the group chat are the top three.

One thing only you can do

The free public web address (lettfolio.github.io/full-plate) still needs GitHub Pages switched on: repository **Settings → Pages → Source: "GitHub Actions"**. Until then the game lives at the private Claude link.

2. What changed in Round 11

The work was split into five areas so the builders wouldn't collide, in the order the red-team report recommended.

A · Loading and saving can't be broken from outside

- Every save (owner, career, Empire, Stars) is checked field by field before it's trusted. Numbers must be real and in range, lists are capped, unknown fields dropped. A crafted file is refused with "That save file is damaged."
- Files over 5 MB are refused before being read; a "gzip bomb" (a tiny file that inflates to 256 MB) is refused in 0.3 seconds using 1 MB of memory (it used to take 13.6 s and 252 MB).
- A new error page catches anything that still crashes and offers *Back to title* and *Delete this game*, so no bad save can brick every device.
- A 300 kB restaurant name is cut to 40 characters. If one game can't sync to the account, only that game stops syncing; the others carry on.
- Games are tagged with the account they belong to: another account's games are hidden, never pushed and never deleted. Backups are capped at two per game and leftover fragments are cleaned up.
- The fuzzer found and fixed one real bug: the rota accepted an empty 7-slot array and saved blanks.

B · Losing is visible and recoverable

- Bank countdown chip in the header, an evening card with one-tap fixes ("Raise prices 10%", links to Stock and Rota, "Borrow £X"), and a morning banner on the last three days.
- Game over no longer deletes anything. The slot shows "Lost — day 93" with *Start over with the same restaurant* and *What happened*.
- A spend that would leave fewer than three days of running costs asks first. The red team's "decor spree" test used to end at £25 with no warning; it now stops at £1,130 with a chef still affordable.
- Disabled buttons say why ("Needs £450 in the bank — you have £120"). On Cosy, the hire fee can go into the overdraft; on Normal/Hard a one-off starter loan is offered.
- A "starter chef" (begin with one chef hired) was built and tested, but left **off**: it made two play styles slightly worse in the 200-seed balance runs.

C · The two end-games work

- In the Empire, a shop you're running hands-on can no longer bankrupt the whole company: head office tops up the till each evening. If head office can't, you're offered "Close this shop and move on" rather than game over. The free £20,000 float exploit is gone, and franchised shops can't be run hands-on (which was double-counting their money).
- A bankrupt Empire gets its own screen with "Try again from the last board meeting". When head office is sinking, the board asks a single clear question: sell a shop, close it, or hold on.
- Parked shops are stored compactly: a 10-shop save fell from 16.5 MB to 0.6 MB.

- Stars: keeping a star is now a little easier than earning it, and the head chef who wants to leave can be kept with a pay rise and a share. Dynasties by year 10 went from 3/20 to 12/20. The "close at the top" ending now needs three stars on two guides in a row. "Michelin" is now "Golden Plate" everywhere.

D · Tablet and reader fit

- Portrait iPad layout, "?" words dialog, skip links and 49 fewer keyboard stops, "Skip to evening", remembered speed, mid-shift autosave and resume, "Tap" instead of "Click" on touch screens, a filtered Stock tab, one consistent money formatter.
- Also a "plain words" pass and a "No grown-up drinks" default, both aimed at a 10-year-old. **Round 11b reversed those two** (section 3). What survived of the word pass is the part that was simply better English: "head office" alongside HQ, "sister restaurant", "Golden Plate" for Michelin.

E · Pipeline and honesty of the tests

- The GitHub build grants itself nothing by default; each step gets only the permission it needs; every third-party action is pinned to an exact commit; Dependabot checks monthly.
- Dependencies upgraded: 18 known advisories (3 critical) → 0. Vitest 4 exposed four slow tests that had been quietly over their time limit.
- The accessibility probe now lives in the repo with a baseline it must not exceed; two tests that had been "fixed" by picking lucky seeds now assert across 16–30 seeds. A corpus of 29 real saves is committed and must always load.
- The font licence ships with the game; a README and a rewritten architecture document; the 1,217-line canvas renderer split into six modules with pixel-identical output.

3. Round 11b: re-aimed at 14

One builder, ten commits (`9d19c0f…5c5508b`), on your two choices: *real drinks on, the hide switch stays*, and *restore the trade words, keep the tips*. Every change is to words, defaults and presentation; the simulation's rules are untouched, which is why the balance table in section 5 is identical.

The trade words, back on screen

- **On screen:** 86 / 86'd (Service), Comp / Comped, HQ (Empire screens, strip, Evening, board, end screen, map), Royalty / Royalties, Franchisee, satellite, tronc, Footfall, "VAT to the taxman", "Running HQ". **In the sim's own lines:** "86'd for today", "royalty holiday", "pays no royalty", "Royalty rises", wholesaler. **In content:** HMRC, VAT, call-out fee, sommelier.
- Every one of them is a *glossary term*: tap it and a one-line meaning appears. Eight entries were added (comp, HQ, franchisee, wholesaler, VAT, HMRC, call-out fee, sommelier). A new `TermText` component gives log lines, board options, events, incidents, reviews and toasts the same tips, and a term inside a button shows its tip without pressing the button.
- The automated "key screen" test was turned round: it used to fail if a trade word appeared; it now strips every term out and fails if a trade word remains *without* a tip.
- The dotted underline that marks a tappable word now shows the first time each word appears, then stops; Settings has "Underline words I can tap" to bring it back. On the day-1 Menu that is 71 underlines → 1 (seventy of the 71 were the word "margin").

Defaults

- **Drinks:** real by default. The switch is now "Hide alcoholic drinks", off unless she turns it on. The temperance list it swaps in was rewritten to read as a real one ("Rhubarb & rose pressé", "Pressed Pinot Noir grape"); drink blurbs say "(Over-18s only.)" instead of "(Grown-ups only.)". One real bug surfaced

here: flipping the switch didn't update the menu until a tab change. Fixed; it had been there since Round 11, hidden because the soft list was the default.

- **Difficulty:** Normal is pre-picked on the start picker and the lease screen. Cosy still starts at 4×; Normal starts at 1× until she picks a speed. "How do I win?" now says the year is nearer ten hours if every service is watched at 1×.
- **Goals card:** from day 8, or once five goals are done, no spotlight and no flash. "Show me" stays; day 1 is unchanged.

Tone

- 51 player-facing lines rewritten across review templates, critic lines, incidents, goals, staff quotes, decor, career and countries text, keeping the same keys and pool sizes so nothing in the balance moved. "Our tummies were rumbling" → "We read the whole menu. Twice." "Very posh" → "Black tie optional, but encouraged." "Yum!" → "Hard to walk past." "They cheered!" → "They cheered. Loudly." The little brother who learned to whistle, grandad's happy dance and "Bring your granny" stayed.
- Exclamation marks dropped from the UI and sim where they were doing the cheering for her: "Oops! Something went wrong." → "Something went wrong."; "Shift done — keep practising!" → "Shift done. Room to improve."; "Never mind!" → "It happens." Earned ones ("What a night!", promotions, the win) are kept.
- Halal rules now say "soft drinks only" rather than "grown-up drinks". README, the brief and every code comment that said "a 10-year-old" now say 14 / 12+.

Checked

Typecheck; 1,241 tests (ten more than Round 11, none removed); build with the main chunk at 199.2 kB of a 200 kB budget; both text audits (117 screens each, nothing under 13 px, no errors); the accessibility probe re-baselined because more words are now tappable terms; balance runs identical; a browser playtest at 1024×768 with touch: Normal pre-selected, lager and house wine on the day-1 menu, "Footfall" and "86" show their tips, Skip to evening works, day 2 runs, the drinks switch swaps the menu and the larder warning at once. Zero page errors.

Left alone, and why

- Saved preferences from Round 11 keep soft drinks, because that round stored "on" as the default and a real choice can't be told from it. One flip in Settings fixes it. New players get real drinks.
- The map's hover tip reads "Your head office (HQ) is here" in words, because a tappable term can't live inside a tooltip.
- Historical round headings in the design notes that mention a 10-year-old were left as history.

4. Every finding and its status

Ids match `docs/RED-TEAM.md`. "Closed" means the red team's own reproduction was re-run on the merged build and no longer causes harm.

Id	Finding (short)	Status	Evidence
S1	Object-typed name in a save white-screens every device	**Closed**	Crafted file refused; CrashGuard page as backstop
S2	300 kB name breaks cloud sync for all games	**Closed**	Name capped at 40 chars; per-slot stall only
S3	No schema validation on any save type	**Closed**	Validators in all four sims; string day, 100k staff, bogus phase all refused

S4	Gzip bomb / size caps	**Closed**	256 MiB bomb refused in 0.3 s, +1 MiB memory
S5	Account hygiene on a shared device	**Closed**	Second account sees 0 of the first's games
S6	Imports stored verbatim; unbounded backups; orphan chunks	**Closed**	Re-serialised on import; ≤2 backups; orphans 9 → 0
S7	CI permissions at workflow level	**Closed**	Default `permissions: {}`; per-job grants
S8	Actions pinned by tag	**Closed**	All six pinned to commit SHAs; Dependabot
S9	Vulnerable dependencies; `--host` by default	**Closed**	18 advisories → 0; Vite 6, Vitest 4
S10	Forged header reads 400k chunks	**Closed**	Chunk count ≤ 8 and must match; 1 read
S11	Stale header after failed write	**Closed**	Header re-read before next push (by design; never reproducible)
S12	Bidi/control characters; dev switches; no CSP	**Partly**	Characters stripped, `?autopilot`/`?perf` dev-gated; no CSP yet, Pages origin shared
S13	Font licence not shipped	**Closed**	OFL.txt shipped; credit in Settings
G1	Hands-on shop bust deletes a running Empire	**Closed**	Head office top-up; bust save runs 120 more days
G2	Cosy staffless £0 trap	**Closed**	Hire fee into overdraft; starter loan; nohire run shows warnings
G3	Stars dynasty near-unwinnable	**Closed**	3/20 → 12/20 by year 10; 1/10 → 7/10 from fork
G4	El Bulli ending too easy	**Closed**	Needs ★★★ on two guides
G5	Franchise counted twice	**Closed**	Hands-on hidden and refused on franchised shops
G6	Free £20k till float	**Closed**	Head office pays a week's float + food; refunded on leaving
G7	Parked-site save bloat	**Closed**	10 shops 16.5 MB → 0.58 MB
G8	Bankruptcy freezes the Empire	**Closed**	EmpireEnd screen; board debt question; sinking card
G9	Prototype-key commands	**Closed**	`__proto__`/`toString` rejected in all dispatchers
G10	NaN Empire arguments; autosave throws	**Closed**	Refused; "Couldn't save" indicator
G11	Stars unknown satellite kinds / NaN	**Closed**	Refused; 5-satellite cap respected
G12	Fork without being offered	**Closed**	Allowed once, from day 365, never over an existing path
G13	Duplicate HIRE ids	**Closed**	Refused
G14	Campaign/transfer/refund micro-exploits; owner profile from UI	**Partly**	All closed in the game; the sim's raw API still accepts SET_OWNER_PROFILE
U1	Portrait 768×1024 broken	**Closed**	38 scrolling screens → 0; no tap < 44 px; no text < 13 px
U2	Day-1 decor spree to £25	**Closed**	Spree now ends at £1,130 after a confirm
U3	Silent losing; game over deletes the save	**Closed**	Countdown chip, card, banner; archive + restart
U4	Stale toasts / wrong-panel hints	**Closed**	Cleared on phase change; wording fixed
U5	Star/Dog label on day 1	**Closed**	"New: judged after 7 days of sales"

U6	Hidden "needs £X" reason	**Closed**	Visible text; unaffordable options greyed
U7	Trade words on key screens	**Closed (re-read for 14)**	Every trade word is a tipped glossary term; test fails on any left without a tip
U8	Alcohol in a child's game	**Closed (re-read for 14)**	Real drinks shown; "Hide alcoholic drinks" switch available; identical play either way
U9	156 keyboard tab stops	**Closed**	107 stops; Tab, Enter reaches Open for service
U10	First year too long	**Partly**	Skip, speed memory, 4× on Cosy; year 1 still ≈ 4.7–6 h
U11	Reload mid-shift loses the shift	**Closed**	Resumes "from 14:00" after reload
U12	Mixed signals (mood reasons, Michelin, Tap/Click, etc.)	**Closed**	All items done
T1	Probe over-reported	**Closed**	Probe in repo with honest baseline
T2	Tests re-seeded to pass	**Closed**	Assert over 16–30 seeds
T3	No save corpus	**Closed**	29 saves committed; all load
T4	Docs out of date	**Closed**	README, ARCHITECTURE, PIPELINE

5. The numbers

Balance — unchanged

Survival rate after one game year, 200 random restaurants each, for seven scripted play styles. Every row is identical to the previous build: none of Round 11's rules touch a well-run restaurant, and Round 11b changed only words and defaults.

Play style	Before (Round 10)	After (Round 11 and 11b)	What it is
typical	90.0%	90.0%	sensible menu, hires when told
balanced	98.5%	98.5%	follows every goal
cheap	68.0%	68.0%	lowest prices, cheapest staff
premium	99.0%	99.0%	high prices, best staff
nohire	0%	0% (now with warnings)	never hires anyone
learner	98.0%	98.0%	mistakes, then corrects
decorator	88.0%	88.0%	spends on decor first

Stars dynasty (10 years)

Run	Before	After
Cold start, 20 seeds, by year 10	3/20	**12/20**
… by year 12	3/20	16/20
From the fork, 10 seeds, by year 10	1/10	**7/10**
Stars lost on guide days (cold)	22	0

Empire (10 years, 5 seeds × 3 chains)

Run	Before	After
Following the board's advice	15/15	15/15 (same years)
Skipping board meetings	13/15	13/15

Size and speed

Measure	Before	After
Main code chunk (budget 200 kB)	195.9 kB	199.2 kB (0.8 kB left)
Dependency advisories	18 (3 critical)	0
Automated tests	1,071	1,241
Gzip-bomb refusal	13.6 s, +252 MB	0.3 s, +1 MB
10-shop Empire save	16.5 MB	0.58 MB
Keyboard stops, day-1 Menu	156	107
Underlined terms, day-1 Menu	71	1
Minutes to day 30 (est.)	≈ 52	≈ 23 with Skip

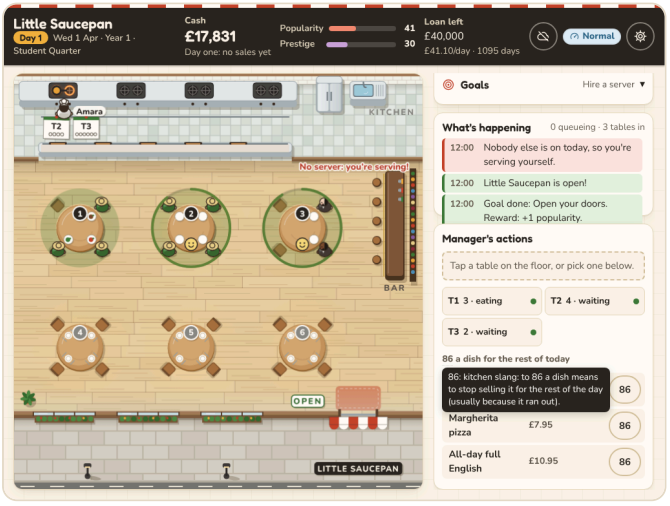
Accessibility probe (39 screens)

Measure	Before	After
Screens scrolling sideways at 768×1024	38	**0**
Text under 13 px (6 sizes × 117 screens)	0	0
Buttons/switches under 44 px	0	0
Tappable glossary words under 44 px	≈ 290	≈ 365–396 (more words are terms now; see section 9)

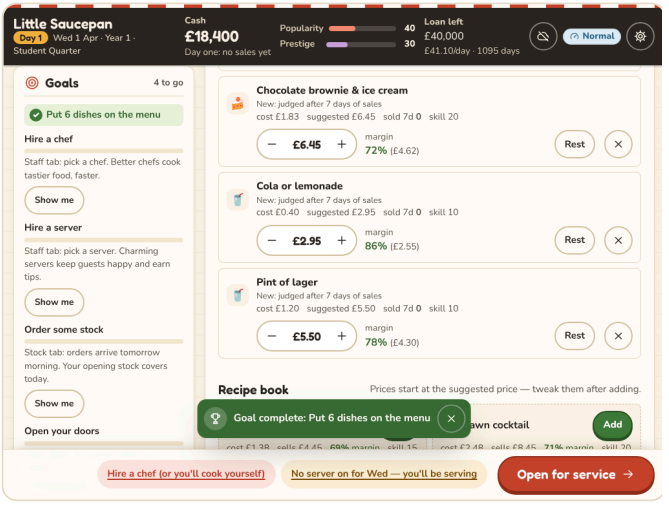
Browser playtests on the published build

All with zero page errors. Round 11b: a new game at 1024×768 with touch to day 2 (Normal pre-set, real drinks, "86" and "Footfall" tips, Skip to evening, drinks switch). Round 11, at 1024×768 and 768×1024 with touch: a new player to day 3; an owner for 7 days with a decor spree and no-hire warnings through to "Lost — day 93" and a restart; the red team's bust-at-flagship Empire save (now topped up) and broke-head-office save (now "Close this shop and move on"); a Stars game; a win; four crafted save files (all refused); a mid-shift reload (resumed); keyboard-only play to "Open for service".

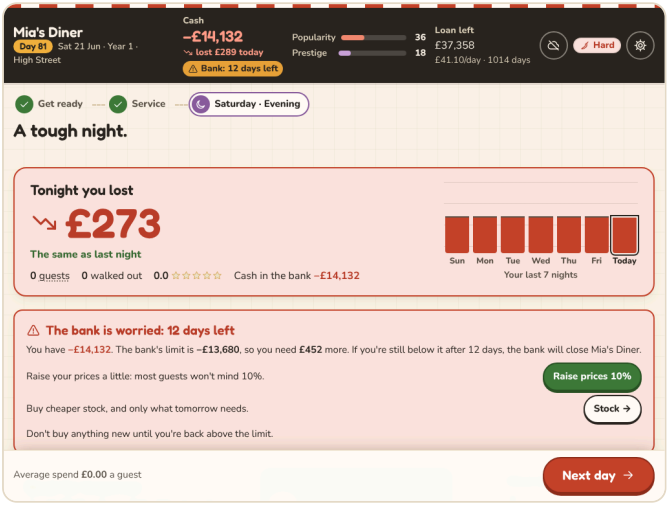
6. In pictures



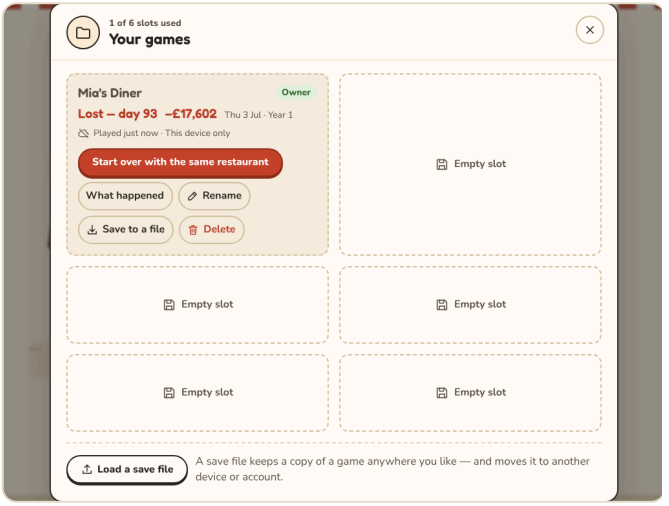
Real words, meaning on tap (Round 11b). The Service panel says "86 a dish for the rest of today"; tapping the word shows "86: kitchen slang: to 86 a dish means to stop selling it for the rest of the day".



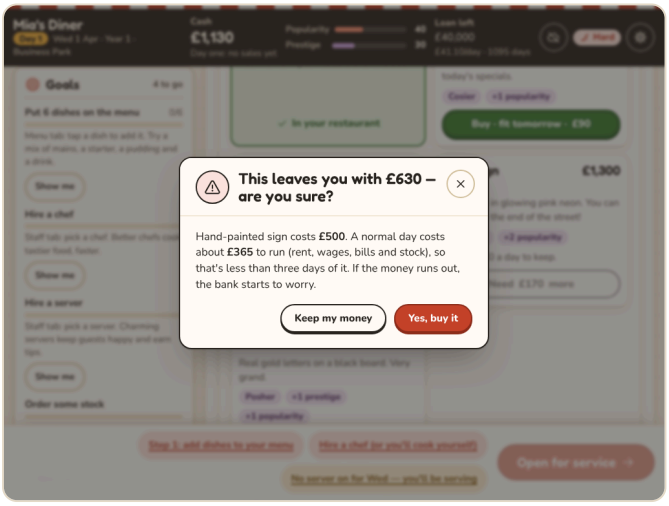
A real drinks list, on Normal, by default. Pint of lager beside the cola; "margin" underlined once, not seventy times; the Normal badge in the header.



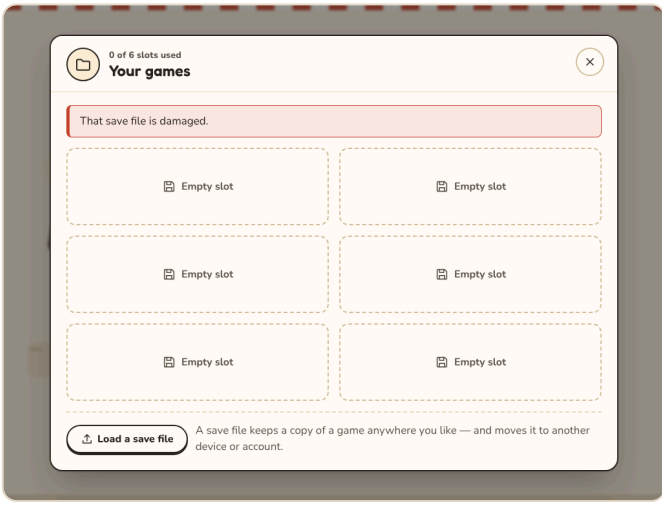
Losing is visible now. Header chip "Bank: 12 days left", the night's loss, and a card that says exactly what the limit is, what she needs, and three things to do about it.



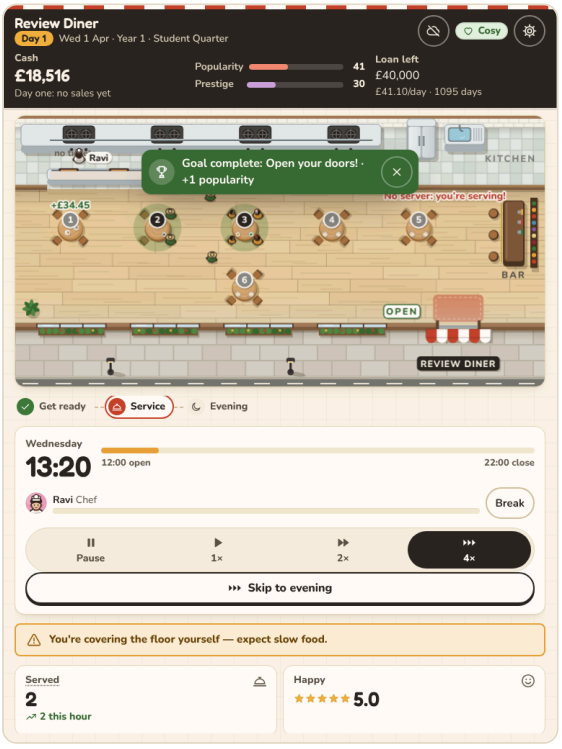
Nothing is deleted. A lost game stays in Your games as "Lost — day 93" with *Start over with the same restaurant* and *What happened*.



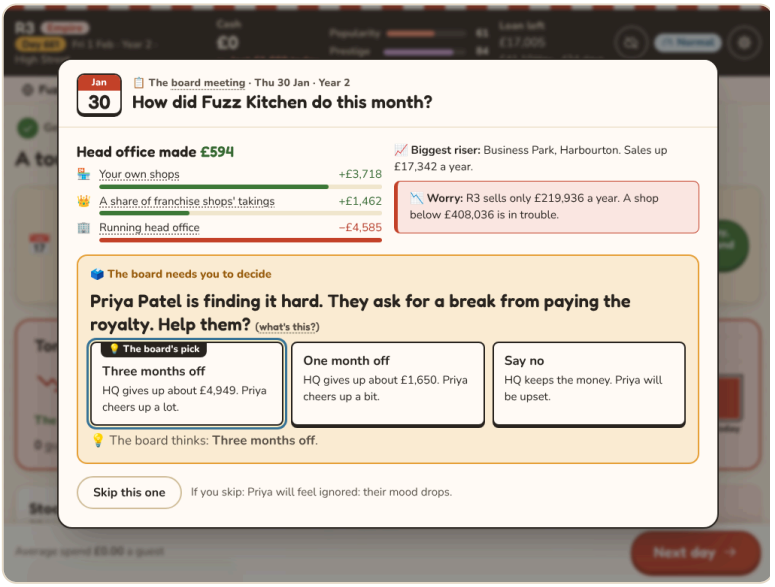
Spending asks first. "This leaves you with £630 — are you sure?" with the cost of a normal day for scale. The red team's spree used to end at £25.



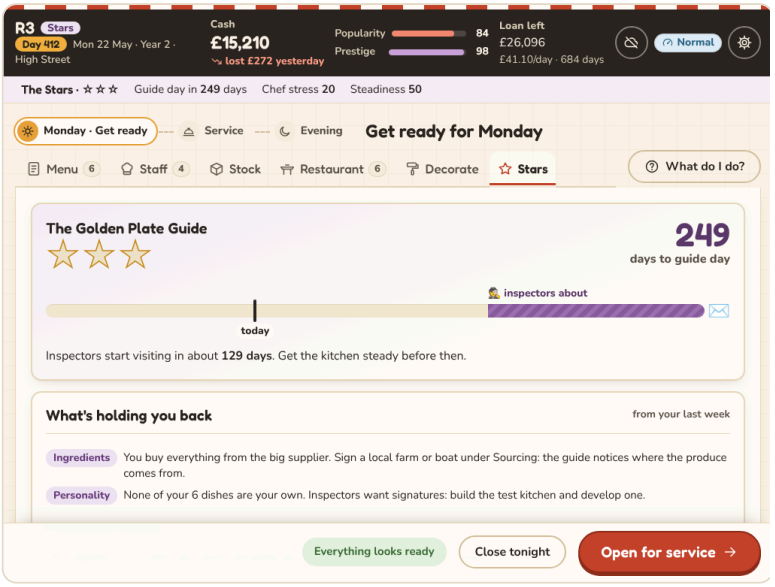
Bad files are refused, not loaded. The red team's crashing file now gets "That save file is damaged." and nothing else happens.



iPad held upright (768×1024). The floor sits above the panel, with "Skip to evening" and speed buttons; no sideways scrolling.



The board meeting (Round 11 screenshot). Since 11b, "HQ" and "royalty" are the words used, each tappable for its meaning.



The Golden Plate Guide (formerly "Michelin") with the countdown to guide day and what's holding the restaurant back.

7. How Full Plate compares with what a 14-year-old plays

Three analysts surveyed the market on 10 November 2026: one the management/tycoon games, one the games younger children play, and, after your correction, one looking specifically at what 14-year-old girls in the UK play and whether Full Plate would read as "for a little kid" to one. This section is that third analyst's work, with the tycoon depth table kept. Every fact about another game comes from a page that was fetched (Sources at the end); anything unconfirmed is marked *unverified*; rows marked † are the analyst's judgement, not a sourced fact. "CSM" is Common Sense Media's recommended age.

7.1 What she and her friends play

- **Nearly all of them play, and much of it is social.** Ofcom (May 2026): 72% of 8–17s game online; 55% sometimes play with people they only know online; about four in ten 11–17s use Roblox, and heavy users aged 8–14 average 1 h 19 min a day on it.

- **Roblox is no longer a little-kid platform.** Its chief executive said in late 2025 that two-thirds of daily users are 13 or over. Its two biggest hits of the past two years were made by teenagers: *Grow a Garden* (a 16-year-old; 22 million players online at once in August 2025) and *Dress to Impress* (started by a 14-year-old; a timed fashion contest judged by other players, with Charli XCX and Lady Gaga tie-ins).
- **The Sims is the stand-out for young women** (YPulse, May 2026). **Don't assume "girls' games":** Bryter's survey of women 16–65 found more play action-adventure (56%) and shooters (49%) than life sims (40%).
- **Her phone is probably her main screen.** The newest UK gender data is old (2019: parents said the smartphone was girls' main gaming device, 79%), but nothing since contradicts it.
- **The cooking games that land with teenagers** are PlateUp!, Overcooked 2, Dave the Diver, Two Point Hospital/Museum, Supermarket Simulator and the 2026 wave of cheap co-op kitchen games on Steam; Papa's survives as nostalgia (TikTok fan clips), not as a first choice.

A gap to know about: the analyst could not open Ofcom's 2025–26 report PDFs or Internet Matters' gender-gap briefing, so there are no verified figures for *UK girls aged 13–15 by game*. The picture above comes from platform data, US youth research and older UK surveys; read it as a direction, not a census.

7.2 The landscape

Game	Where	UK price	PEGI / CSM	Money model	Why a 14-year-old plays it †
Full Plate	Browser (tablet, PC); phone untested	Free	Not rated	None: no ads, purchases or chat	Her own restaurant, made by her dad
Roblox: *Dress to Impress*	Any device	Free	PEGI 7; CSM 13+	Robux; limited-time items	Fashion, self-expression, being rated by others
Roblox: *Grow a Garden*	Any device	Free	As Roblox	Robux to skip waiting; pets from **loot boxes**	Talked about at school; trading
Roblox: *Restaurant Tycoon 2*	Any device	Free	As Roblox	11 game passes, 41 paid items	The "restaurant game" everyone knows (1.7 bn visits)
The Sims 4	PC, Mac, consoles	Base game free; packs extra	PEGI 12; CSM 12+	"A lot" of paid packs (CSM)	Identity, relationships, building
Stardew Valley	Everywhere	From £8.67	PEGI 12 (casino); CSM 10+	Paid once	Calm, long, romance; co-op with a friend
Animal Crossing: NH	Switch, Switch 2	Switch 2 Edition £54.99	PEGI 3	Paid add-on	Decorating; visits with friends
PlateUp!	PC, consoles	£16.75	PEGI 3	Paid once	Friends shouting in a kitchen; 2 m copies on Steam
Overcooked! 2	Everywhere	From £8.67	PEGI 3; CSM 8+	Paid, DLC	Party and sleepover game
Dave the Diver	Consoles, PC; phones from Sept 2026	Switch 2 Edition £16.99	PEGI 12	Paid once	Silly, stylish, funny cutscenes; 5 m+ sold

Two Point Hospital / Museum	PC, consoles	Museum US$29.99 (UK unverified)	PEGI 7; CSM 10+	Paid, DLC	British humour; easy to understand
Supermarket Simulator	PC, consoles	US$9.99–19.99 (UK unverified)	PEGI 12	Paid once	Satisfying routine; TikTok fodder; 4-player online
Good Pizza, Great Pizza	Phone, Switch, PC	Free with gems; ad-free on Apple Arcade	Apple 4+; CSM 5+	Ads and gems	Funny customers; easy on a phone
Chef Life	Switch and others	unverified	PEGI 3; in-game purchases	Paid, extras	The closest rival to the Golden Plate path
New on Steam in 2026 (*KuloNiku*, *Galaxy Burger*, *Kebab Chefs!*)	PC	≈ US$11.99	None listed	Paid once	Cheap, co-op (4–8 players), made to stream

7.3 The parent's checklist, re-weighted for 14

Still matters, and more than at 10: spending traps (she may have her own money and birthday Robux; loot boxes, limited-time items and "pay to skip waiting" are aimed squarely at her age group), strangers (on Roblox a checked 13–15-year-old can be matched for chat with 16–17s), time sinks with no stopping point, and data (Roblox now face-scans before chat). **Matters less now †:** reading level, 44 px tap targets and Bigger text (keep them, but they no longer sell the game), and alcohol *references* at PEGI 12 level: Stardew's villagers drink and one is shown passed out; Cook, Serve, Delicious! 3 lists wine, rum and brandy at PEGI 7; PlateUp! uses wine at PEGI 3. **New for 14 †:** can she play it with or show it to friends? Is it on the device she actually uses? Does it treat her as capable?

	Full Plate	Sims 4	Stardew	PlateUp!	Overcooked 2	Two Point	Dave the Diver	Roblox	Good Pizza
Purchases	**None**	**Many packs**	None	None	**DLC**	**DLC**	None	**Robux; loot boxes**	**Gems**
Limited-time pressure	**None**	unverified	None	None	None	None	None	**Yes**	unverified
Chat with strangers	**None**	**User content; mods**	**Typed chat in co-op**	**Online talk**	Emotes	None	None	**Yes, after a face check**	None
Stopping points †	**Every evening; Skip**	**Weak**	Each day	Each run	Each level	Each star	Each day	**Weak; rewards for being online**	Each day
Privacy	**0 third-party requests**	Account	Platform	Platform	Platform	Platform	Platform	**Account + face scan**	**Ads, tracking (unverified)**
Content at 14 †	Mild; real drinks, hideable	**Romance, "woohoo"**	**Drinking, romance, casino**	Mild	Mild	**Toilet humour**	Mild (PEGI 12)	**Anything user-made**	Mild

Challenge †	**Normal and Hard are real; Cosy can't fail**	Low	Low–medium	High	High	Medium	Medium	Low	Low
Play with friends	**No**	**Share builds**	**Co-op 1–4**	**Co-op 1–4**	**Co-op 1–4**	No	No	**Everything**	No
Self-expression †	**45 items, 9 fixed slots**	**Huge**	**Farm, house, clothes**	**Kitchen layout**	**Chef skins**	**Room layout**	Little	**Huge (DTI)**	**Shop decor**
On her phone	**Untested**	**No**	**Yes**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**From Sept 2026**	**Yes**	**Yes**

Reading the table. Full Plate still wins every *safety* row. That is now a smaller part of the decision, because at 14 she chooses for herself, and it loses the three rows she cares about: friends, self-expression and her phone.

7.4 Does it feel "for a little kid"?

The analyst's short answer: in places, yes, and the cause was Round 11's wording, not the game underneath. The simulation (rent, wages, loans, franchise contracts, inspectors, board meetings) is deeper than anything in the landscape table except Chef Life and the PC tycoons. Round 11 pushed the *surface* down to age 10. The specific things named as patronising were: "No grown-up drinks" on by default, with swaps like "dandelion & burdock" on a Golden Plate drinks list; review voices like "Our tummies were rumbling" and "Yum!"; the dotted learn-this-word underline on 71 words of the first Menu; a goals card that keeps nudging; and the removal of the real words, when "a 14-year-old would rather learn '86' than be shielded from it". **Every one of those is what Round 11b changed** (section 3). The cartoon look is not the problem: PlateUp!, Overcooked, Two Point and Stardew are all cartoons. Over-explaining was.

What already read as respectful, and was kept: the career lines ("You were the calmest person in the building on Saturday. That's leadership."), the dry critic text ("You're proud. Mostly."), "head office" and "sister restaurant" as plain good English, Cosy at 4× as a choice rather than a default, and real stakes on Normal and Hard. The lesson the analyst drew from Two Point (in on the joke), PlateUp! (trusted to fail), Stardew and The Sims (no reading-age softening) and Dave the Diver (humour in style, not explanation): *respect means trusting her to fail, letting jokes have a little edge, using real words with a tip on tap, and offering help when asked rather than all the time.*

7.5 Ahead and behind, for a teenager

	Full Plate	Ahead or behind †
Depth	Two complete end-games, franchising, a career that starts as an employee, staff with personalities, loans, board meetings	**Well ahead of every free or phone game; level with the PC tycoons**
Challenge	Normal busts 10% of "typical" players in year 1; Hard is tougher; Cosy can't fail	**Ahead if she picks Hard; but no challenge levels or scores to beat**
Aesthetics	A tidy, warm cartoon look; quiet sounds	**Behind on style and music: no soundtrack, no stylish moments, nothing she'd screenshot**

Self-expression	45 items in 9 fixed slots; a restaurant name; 6 looks for her career character	**Well behind Sims, Dress to Impress and Animal Crossing: no logo, uniforms, colour scheme or free placement, though the brief asked for "uniforms, logo, theme"**
Humour	Dry, sharper since 11b	**Still behind Two Point and Dave the Diver: too few jokes**
Shareable moments	"Save a picture" on the win screen only	**Behind: nothing to post in a group chat during play**
Co-op or social	None	**Behind PlateUp!, Overcooked, Stardew and all of Roblox**
Speed to the interesting part	Day 30 in about 23–30 min on Cosy; the Empire-or-Stars choice after 4.7–6 h	**Behind: a PlateUp! run is 15 days; one Two Point star unlocks the next hospital**
Device	Tablet and PC; portrait iPad fixed	**Behind if her main screen is a phone (untested)**
Safety and cost	Free, no purchases, no chat, no trackers	**Far ahead, though that matters more to you than to her**

7.6 The management games (for depth)

Game	Platforms	Price	Rating	Depth (1–5) †	Hands-on cooking	End-game
Full Plate	Browser (tablet, PC)	Free	Not rated	4	Yes (optional shift)	Two: worldwide Empire or a Golden Plate group
Restaurant Empire II (2009)	Windows	£16.75	None listed	4	No	Two campaigns of 34 missions
Recipe for Disaster (2022)	Windows	US$14.99	None listed	4	No	Turn-round scenarios + freeplay
Chef: A Restaurant Tycoon (2020)	Windows	US$19.99	None listed	3	No	Story challenges; sandbox
Tavern Keeper (Early Access 2025)	Windows	US$29.99	"Family friendly" tag	4	No	Storybook campaign
PlateUp! (2022)	Windows, Switch	£16.75	PEGI 3	3	Yes	Runs that end on failure
Chef Life (2023)	Switch, PC, PlayStation	unverified	PEGI 3; ESRB "Alcohol reference"	3	Yes	A Michelin star
Cook, Serve, Delicious! 3 (2020)	PC, Mac	£15.49	PEGI 7	2	Yes	Road trip of 387 levels
Big Ambitions (1.0 Aug 2026)	PC, Mac	US$25.99	None listed	5 (whole city)	unverified	unverified

† the analyst's judgement from store-page features, not a published score. Most PC-only Steam games carry no PEGI/ESRB rating at all.

7.7 What she would compare it to

Probably **Restaurant Tycoon 2 on Roblox**, because that is "the restaurant game" at school: free and lively, with friends in it, but selling passes and items, with chat, and never ending. Next to it Full Plate is deeper,

quieter and hers alone. For a parent who plays sims, **Two Point**, next to which Full Plate is smaller, with fewer jokes and no music, but a tighter business model and two real endings. The fair summary: safer than anything in the list, as deep as the PC tycoons, and short on the things a 14-year-old picks a game for: making it hers, showing it to friends, and a bit of style.

8. Ideas worth borrowing, re-ranked for 14

Each tied to a named game and costed. The deterministic simulation makes several of these cheap: a shared seed is a fair puzzle, and most of the tone work is text.

#	Idea	From	Why it suits her †	Cost
1	**Brand kit.** A logo (shape, colour, lettering), staff uniforms, a house colour, sign and menu style, shown on the shopfront and the menu card.	Dress to Impress; The Sims 4; the brief's own "uniforms, logo, theme"	Self-expression is what she does in every game she picks. It makes the restaurant hers, not Dad's.	**Medium**
2	**Daily challenge, same for everyone.** One shared starting position a day ("rescue this café by Friday"), scored, so she can compare with you or a friend.	PlateUp! runs; Two Point star goals; Recipe for Disaster rescues	Challenge, short sessions and bragging rights. Fixed seeds plus a score screen; no online system needed.	**Cheap–medium**
3	**Postcard any time.** A stylish picture of her room, team or best night, with the logo on it.	Dress to Impress catwalk moment; the win screen's own "Save a picture"	Something to post in the group chat; the cheapest social feature there is. The picture code exists.	**Cheap**
4	**A voice with an edge.** A local radio or "Food Gossip" ticker with puns and running jokes; sharper critics; one rude-but-fair food blogger.	Two Point Hospital's DJ; Dave the Diver	Humour that treats her as clever. Text only.	**Cheap**
5	**A rival with attitude.** A named chef across the road with a feed of smug posts; beat them on reviews.	Good Pizza, Great Pizza (Alicante)	Banter and a story at 14, rather than "cheeky but never cruel" at 10.	**Cheap**
6	**Regulars with storylines.** Eight to ten named customers with small dramas (a first date, a break-up, a food blogger's comeback), each with a VIP order that unlocks something.	Dave the Diver VIPs; Stardew villagers	People and gossip, not market segments.	**Medium**
7	**Shorter arcs.** A "quick year" or 30-day chapters, each ending in a star score, so the big choice comes in an evening, not a month.	Two Point (one star unlocks the next site); PlateUp! 15-day runs	Gets her to the interesting part faster; the red team's U10 is still open.	**Medium**
8	**Soundtrack and style.** A few tracks with a jukebox in the room (Music is already a decor slot); a "service rush" beat.	Two Point radio; Dave the Diver	Mood matters at 14; silence reads as unfinished.	**Medium (music to license or commission)**
9	**Visit a friend's restaurant.** Share a code; a friend opens a read-only copy to look round and leave a star review.	Restaurant Tycoon 2; Animal Crossing visits	Social without chat or strangers. Builds on cloud saves.	**Medium**

10	**Invent a dish.** Name it, pick the ingredients, set the price, see how it sells.	Chef; Recipe for Disaster recipe editors	Creativity plus real business sense.	**Medium**
11	**Online co-op shift with one friend.** Invite code, emotes only, no text chat.	PlateUp!; Overcooked; Galaxy Burger; Kebab Chefs!	What teenagers actually play together; invite-only keeps the strangers risk out.	**Expensive (networking)**
12	**Phone-sized layout.** Test and fix the game at 390×844.	Every game in the landscape she plays on a phone	If her main screen is a phone, nothing above matters until this is done. Not a borrowed idea, but it belongs on the list.	**Medium (unknown until probed)**

> **If only three get done:** 1 (brand kit), 2 (daily challenge) and 3 (postcard). The first makes it hers, the second gives it a reason to come back, with you to beat, and the third gives her something to show. The "grown-up mode" the analyst ranked first is Round 11b, already done.

What happened to the ideas for a 10-year-old

Earlier idea	At 14
Regulars	**Changes:** from favourite dishes to storylines and VIP requests (#6)
Collection book	**Drops down:** keep it as a cookbook of signature dishes, tied to Invent a dish (#10)
Juice (coin pops, cheers, sparkle)	**Changes:** less confetti, more style: music, a satisfying rush moment, the postcard (#3, #8)
Rival	**Survives, sharper** (#5)
Friendship hearts with staff	**Drops:** reads as young; fold staff relationships into storylines
Test kitchen	**Changes** into Invent a dish (#10)
Seasonal days	**Survives** as themed weeks (Bonfire Night, exam season, prom) that leave a lasting item behind, never "log in or miss it"
Assist mode for the shift	**Survives, lower priority;** call it "Relaxed shift", not assist
Photo mode	**Survives and moves up** (#3)
Co-op with Dad on one device	**Changes:** a friend by invite (#11); the Dad-versus-me daily challenge (#2) is the cheap version
Star rating she can break down; food-truck first chapter	**Still fine**, but neither moves the needle for 14; park them

9. What's next, and what's still open

Still open after Rounds 11 and 11b

- **Phone-sized screens have never been tested.** The probe and the playtests run at 1280×800, 1024×768 and 768×1024. If her main device is a phone, this is the first thing to find out, and it may be a large job.
- **U10 — the first year is still long** (≈ 4.7–6 hours, nearer ten at 1× on Normal). "Skip to evening" helps; shorter arcs (idea 7) is the real fix.
- **Glossary words are small tap targets.** More words are tappable terms since 11b (≈ 365–396 per screen size, up from ≈ 290), and they are 17–30 px tall. They are out of the keyboard order and every button and switch is 44 px, but the probe still counts them. Either make them 44 px or stop counting them; a decision, not a bug.

- **The main code chunk is at 199.2 kB of a 200 kB budget.** The next screen feature has to move something out first (another lazy-loaded screen would do it).
- **Round 11 preferences keep soft drinks.** Anyone who saved a setting during Round 11 stays on the temperance list until they flip "Hide alcoholic drinks" off. New players get real drinks.
- **S12 — no Content Security Policy** yet, and the GitHub Pages address shares an origin with any other project on that account. Low risk for a private family game; worth doing before sharing widely.
- **G14 — the sim's raw API** still accepts the owner-profile command; the game blocks it. Only matters to someone scripting the sim directly.
- **The probe and audit don't run in CI** (they need a browser on the runner). PIPELINE.md describes the extra job.
- "Try again from the last board meeting" is in memory only: after a reload the bankrupt-Empire screen offers "Start over" instead.

Suggested order

1. **You:** switch on GitHub Pages (Settings → Pages → Source "GitHub Actions"), then open lettfolio.github.io/full-plate on her iPad. Or import the repo on Vercel if you'd rather (root `packages/game`, Vite).
2. **Her:** a playtest, on whatever device she'd actually use, on Normal, without you explaining anything. Watch what she taps first, where she laughs, where she stops, and whether she asks to show anyone. That's the Round 12 brief, and it will settle the phone question.
3. **Round 12:** ideas 1, 2 and 3 above (brand kit, daily challenge, postcard), plus whatever the phone test turns up.

Where everything is

- The game: the Claude artifact link (version 12), and GitHub `Lettfolio/full-plate` at commit `5c5508b`.
- Findings and status: `docs/RED-TEAM.md` (also in the Project). The reviewer's account: `docs/REVIEW.md`, "Round 11". Round 11b's word list, defaults and every rewritten line: `docs/UI-NOTES.md` and `docs/CONTENT-NOTES.md`, "Round 11b — age 14".
- The three market notes in full: `docs/MARKET-COMPARISON.md` (also in the Project).
- Design notes per area: `docs/SIM-NOTES.md`, `EMPIRE-NOTES.md`, `STARS-NOTES.md`, `SAVES.md`, `PIPELINE.md`.

Sources for the market comparison

Fetched 10 November 2026. Pages that would not open are not used anywhere above.

For the 14-year-old comparison (sections 7.1–7.5, 8)

- Ofcom: our latest look at UK children's media lives (21 May 2026)
- Ofcom: Children and parents: media use and attitudes 2025
- PocketGamer.biz: Ofcom warns children remain exposed... Roblox (21 May 2026)
- Roblox Q3 2025 earnings call (Alphaspread)
- GGRecon: Roblox daily players fall for the first time (Q3 2026)
- Wikipedia: Grow a Garden · Dress to Impress · Dave the Diver · Two Point Hospital · PlateUp!
- YPulse: Gen Z's top 10 favourite games in 2026
- Women in Games: Bryter survey of women gamers
- Ukiepedia: Player diversity and demographics
- Common Sense Media: The Sims 4 · Stardew Valley · Two Point Hospital
- NME: The Sims 4 free to play · EA: Sims 4 expansion packs
- Family Gaming Database: The Sims 4 · Minecraft · Animal Crossing · Dreamlight Valley · PlateUp! · Stardew Valley · Supermarket Simulator · Cook, Serve, Delicious! 3
- RTÉ: are your kids' video games age-appropriate?

- PriceSpy UK: Stardew Valley · Nintendo Life: Dave the Diver Switch 2 Edition · hotukdeals: Two Point Hospital · Deku Deals: Two Point Museum
- Push Square: Supermarket Simulator on PS5
- Coolmath Games: Papa's games breakdown · WASDland: best cooking games on Steam (Nov 2026) · Bonus Action: Steam Cooking Fest 2026

For the younger-children and tycoon surveys (sections 7.2, 7.6 and the earlier report)

- Chef: A Restaurant Tycoon Game, Steam
- Restaurant Empire II, Steam
- Restaurant Empire II UK price, COST.games
- Cook, Serve, Delicious! 3?!, Steam
- Cook, Serve, Delicious! 3 UK price, COST.games
- PlateUp!, WASDland
- PlateUp! UK price, COST.games
- PlateUp!, Nintendo UK
- Recipe for Disaster, Steam
- Tavern Keeper, Steam
- Tavern Master, Steam
- Cooking Simulator, Steam
- Cooking Simulator 2: Better Together, Steam
- Chef Life, Nintendo UK
- Chef Life, ESRB
- Good Pizza, Great Pizza, App Store (Ireland)
- Good Pizza, Great Pizza (Switch), Time Extension
- Common Sense Media: Good Pizza, Great Pizza
- 9to5Mac: Apple Arcade May line-up
- Restaurant Tycoon 2, Roblox Developer Forum
- Restaurant Tycoon 2, RoTrends
- My Restaurant!, RoTrends
- TechCrunch: Roblox age checks for chat
- Ask About Games: Roblox (PEGI 7)
- Pocket Tactics: Roblox age rating
- Big Ambitions, Steam 250
- Two Point Museum, ESRB
- Common Sense Media: Overcooked! 2
- Nintendo Life: Overcooked! All You Can Eat
- PriceSpy UK: Overcooked! All You Can Eat
- Gematsu: Overcooked! 2 Switch 2 Edition
- Common Sense Media: Cooking Fever
- App Store (UK): Cooking Fever
- App Store (UK): Papa's Freezeria To Go!
- SteamDB: Papa's Pizzeria Deluxe
- Flipline Blog
- Common Sense Media: Toca Kitchen 2
- App Store (UK): Toca Boca World
- Common Sense Media: Cooking Mama
- Nintendo World Report: Cooking Mama: Cookstar
- SuperParent: Cooking Mama Cuisine
- Common Sense Media: Diner DASH Adventures
- Common Sense Media: My Cafe
- Common Sense Media: Disney Dreamlight Valley
- Dreamlight Valley Wiki: Chez Remy
- Nintendo Life: Animal Crossing 3.0 and Switch 2 Edition
- Nintendo UK: Pokémon Café ReMix
- Bandai Namco: One Piece Grand Gourmet

Full Plate facts come from the project's own documents and the Round 11 and 11b reviews, read without changes. The three analysts' full notes (with every game surveyed, including the unverified ones, and the pages they tried but could not read) are in `docs/MARKET-COMPARISON.md`.